



### First smart glass Titan EyeX

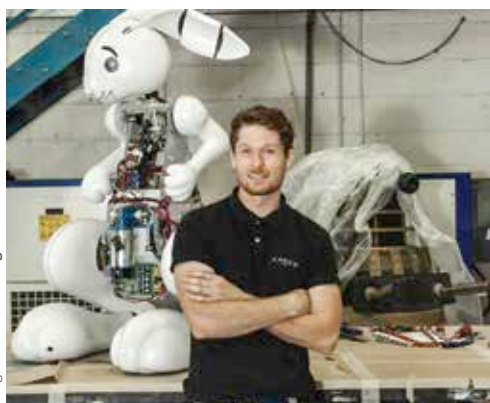
Titan Eye+ launches first smart glasses Titan EyeX with audio and other features.  
<https://digit.in/feb22-18>



### Louis vuitton Tambour Horizon

Louis vuitton unveils fully-customisable Tambour Horizon light up smartwatch.  
<https://digit.in/feb22-19>

Image credit: Rob Greig



An SFX technician is tasked with creating realistic visual effects on-set

budget is decided and approved, SFX technicians begin working on designing any effects, vehicles, robots, or creatures needed.

Once production begins, SFX technicians need to ensure that their effects work as intended, with no collateral damage. This may include manipulating arms for puppets, pumping realistic-looking blood, operating mechanised objects, or manning fog or rain machines. SFX technicians may also be tasked with creating realistic looking makeup or prosthetics for a particular character. These individuals are usually referred to as 'SFX artists'. After the shooting has ended, SFX technicians must ensure the safe removal and storage of all the equipment used to create the effects.

Now, you have an understanding of what SFX technicians are expected to do during film and TV series production. So, you're interested but before you go ahead, you need to know what education, qualifications, and skills you may need to succeed in this career path.

### WHAT NEXT? EDUCATION AND SKILLS REQUIRED

Before delving into the education and qualifications requirements, there are a few things an aspirant must have to become a successful special effects technician. First off, you need to be extremely creative and come up with inventive ways to convey the gist of the scene. If you've got natural curios-

ity within you and are what people deem as 'a jack of all trades', then you are already halfway through. Okay, maybe one-fourth way through. You also need to be a quick thinker and should be able to adapt to conditions and situations immediately since film sets can get pretty unpredictable. Lastly, being a team player is a must since you not only have to work with your own special effects team, but also the director, producers, video editing team, VFX team, and actors.

The SFX industry has no specific set of pre-requisite educational qualifications. However, entrants must have a degree or background in some relevant field such as art design, engineering, stage crafts, or make-up. Some universities and colleges, especially overseas, run specialist courses in subjects like technical arts and special effects which could be very beneficial in kick-starting your career. If you're working with animatronics or robots, you may need to have a strong background in mechanical or electrical engineering.

SFX technicians also need to have an understanding of computer technology and programming, in some instances, to work with rigs to trigger them via a computer. It is also beneficial to have some hands-on experience in theatre production and filmmaking, so try getting internships in film studios.

In India, you will not find too many jobs for SFX technicians listed



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### AT-HOME DIY FOR BUDDING SFX-ERS

Try to simulate your very own gunshot wound at home using anything that can pump liquid. For example: a diwali water pichkari or pistol. You can fill it up with water mixed with red food colouring and some corn syrup. Then, cut a little hole in an old T-shirt and hide it behind you and begin spurting the liquid through your shirt. Ask someone to record it and send us a video at [editor@digit.in](mailto:editor@digit.in)!

### SKILLS THAT MAY BE REQUIRED AS AN SFX TECHNICIAN

- Moulding
- PC know-how
- Mechanical work
- Metal-work
- Robotics
- Electronics
- Explosives
- Make up
- 3D printing
- Welding or plumbing

on job-finding websites such as naukri.com or Monster. It is best to attempt to directly contact studios and go to them with your body of work. Once you've racked up some experience and built contacts in the industry, you will find it easier to get your next gig. Additionally, you can also aspire to go overseas, ideally after you've racked up some experience or after taking up a specialised course there.

If this line of work is something that interests you, it is best to get started as early as possible with your preparation since special effects technicians need to be well-versed with a lot of things. Once you have racked up some experience in this field, showcase your existing portfolio (however big or small) to studios and you may well be on your way to creating some magic, like building a rig to collapse an entire castle, or creating what could be the next Yoda. **d**

Image credit: vizspcialeffects